

EDUCATION

- Aug 2025–
present **PhD in Computational Linguistics and Phonetics**
University of Zurich (UZH), Switzerland
- Supervisors: Professor Dr Volker Dellwo, Dr Elisa Pellegrino, & Professor Pascal Belin (Aix-Marseille University, France)
- Project: *Attention to vocal identity cues*
- Oct 2024–
Jun 2025 **MPhil in Theoretical and Applied Linguistics**
University of Cambridge, United Kingdom
- Supervisor: Dr Kirsty McDougall
- Grade: Distinction (84%)
- Dissertation: *Perceived voice similarity within and across languages: A study of Cantonese–English bilingual speakers*
- Sep 2020–
Jun 2024 **BA in Language Science & Honours Programme in International Organisation Studies**
Shanghai International Studies University (SISU), China
- Supervisor: Professor Xiaoming Jiang
- Cumulative GPA: 3.95/4
- Thesis: *Is thematic role assignment syntactic or semantic in nature? Evidence from computational modelling on naturalistic fMRI*

FUNDING & AWARDS

- Jun 2026–
May 2029 **Digitalization Initiative of the Zurich Higher Education Institutions Innovation Program Project Call Grant**
University of Zurich & Zurich University of Applied Sciences
- Project: *Fake or real? Exploring brain signals for deepfake voice detection (#50)*
- Role: Contributor
- Amount: CHF 255,000 (£241,640)
- Aug 2025–
Jul 2028 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Doctoral Networks Grant, Horizon Europe**
European Research Executive Agency & Swiss State Secretariat for Education, Research and Innovation
- Project: *Voice Communication Sciences (#101168998)*
- Role: Fellow
- Amount: €303,567 (£263,170)
- Oct 2025–
Jun 2026 **Research Travel Grants**
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, University of Zurich
- Role: Lead researcher
- Amount: CHF 3,000 (£2,830)
- Dec 2024–
Jun 2025 **Postgraduate Travel and Research Grant**
Christ's College, University of Cambridge
- Role: Lead researcher
- Amount: £1,650

Jun 2024	First Class Honours Scholarship <i>Shanghai International Studies University</i> - Amount: CN¥ 50,000 (£5,550)
Sep 2020– Apr 2024	National Undergraduate Training Programme for Innovation and Entrepreneurship Grant <i>Shanghai International Studies University</i> - Project: <i>Predicting voice discrimination ability from EEG signals</i> (#202310271021) - Role: Lead researcher - Amount: CN¥ 18,400 (£2,050)
Mar 2021– Mar 2024	Outstanding Student Awards & Scholarships <i>Shanghai International Studies University</i> - Amount: CN¥ 8,800 (£980)
Oct 2023	Honours College Overseas Exchange Scholarship <i>Shanghai International Studies University</i> - Amount: CN¥ 10,000 (£1,120)
Aug 2023	Korea University Global e-School Programme Scholarship <i>Korea Foundation, Ministry of Foreign Affairs of South Korea</i> - Amount: US\$ 2,850 (£2,150)

PUBLICATIONS

In prep	Xu, T. , Jiang, X., & Dellwo, V. Context-dependent acoustic dimensions underlying voice discrimination.
Under review	Xu, T. , & Jiang, X. Voice perception across languages: Reduced similarity between speakers, stable identity within speakers. <i>Journal of Speech, Language, and Hearing Research</i> .
Accepted	Xu, T. , & Dellwo, V. Learning speaker identities in dialogue: Conversational familiarisation modulates response bias and confidence in voice recognition. In <i>Proceedings of Interspeech 2026</i> .
Accepted	Xu, T. , Li, X., Jiang, X., & Dellwo, V. Human-like cross-language generalisation in deep neural speaker embeddings and its acoustic foundations. In <i>Proceedings of Interspeech 2026</i> .
2026	Xu, T. , Jiang, X., & Dellwo, V. Dominant role of temporal–prosodic cues in sentence-level voice discrimination: Insights from interpretable machine learning. In <i>Proceedings of Speech Prosody 2026</i> (pp. 609–613). https://doi.org/10.21437/SpeechProsody.2026-123
2025	Xu, T. A critical review of voice-space models. <i>Cambridge Occasional Papers in Linguistics</i> , 17, 22–36. https://www.copil.mml.cam.ac.uk/files/v17_Xu.pdf
2025	Xu, T. , Jiang, X., Zhang, P., & Wang, A. (2025). Introducing the Sisu Voice Matching Test (SVMT): A novel tool for assessing voice discrimination in Chinese. <i>Behavior Research Methods</i> , 57(3), Article 86. https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-025-02608-3
2025	Xu, T. , Li, J., & Jiang, X. (2025). Semantic processing of argument structure during naturalistic story listening: Evidence from computational modeling on fMRI. <i>NeuroImage</i> , 314, Article 121253. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuroimage.2025.121253

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- May 26–29, 2026 **Xu, T.**, Jiang, X., & Dellwo, V. *Dominant role of temporal–prosodic cues in sentence-level voice discrimination: Insights from interpretable machine learning* [Poster presentation]. Speech Prosody 2026, Philadelphia, PA, United States.
- Dec 18–19, 2025 **Xu, T.**, Li, J., & Jiang, X. *Is argument structure processing syntactic or semantic in nature? Evidence from computational modeling on naturalistic fMRI* [Poster presentation]. Computational Psycholinguistics Meeting 2025, Utrecht, The Netherlands. <https://openreview.net/forum?id=Yl7cxV5P4r>
- Jun 19–20, 2025 **Xu, T.**, Li, J., & Jiang, X. *Semantic processing of argument structure during naturalistic story listening: Evidence from computational modeling on fMRI* [Poster presentation]. 19th Lancaster Linguistics and English Language Postgraduate Conference, Lancaster, United Kingdom.
- Apr 18, 2025 **Xu, T.**, Li, J., & Jiang, X. *Semantic processing of argument structure during naturalistic story listening: Evidence from computational modeling on fMRI* [Paper presentation]. The Sixth Annual Emory Undergraduate Linguistics Conference.

INVITED TALKS

- Sep 24, 2025 *Testing the multidimensional nature of voice perception: Past findings and future directions.* Colloquium Phonetics and Speech Sciences, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland.

TEACHING

- Feb–May 2026 **Phonetics and Speech Sciences Reading Group** (Instructor: Volker Dellwo)
University of Zurich
- Coordinator of the Bayesian Methods subgroup
- Apr 2026 **Experiments with speech** (Instructor: Volker Dellwo)
University of Zurich
- One guest lecture on speech synthesis
- Sep 2023–Jan 2024 **Syntax** (Instructor: Jialei Zhu)
Shanghai International Studies University
- Teaching assistant
- Sep 2023–Jan 2024 **Logic** (Instructor: Jialei Zhu)
Shanghai International Studies University
- Teaching assistant

STUDENT SUPERVISION

- Jan 2026–present **Meng Yao.** *EEG evidence for the role of speaker variability in statistical learning of word boundaries.*
MA in Linguistics, University of Zurich
- Cosupervisor (Primary supervisor: Volker Dellwo)

MEMBERSHIPS & SERVICE

- 2026–present **Member**
International Phonetic Association; International Speech Communication Association; Society for the Neurobiology of Language

Oct 2024– **Member & Linguistics Olympiad Assessor**

Jun 2025 *Cambridge University Linguistics Society*

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

RESEARCH & DATA ANALYSIS

- Python, R, MATLAB, and SPSS Statistics for statistical analysis and data visualisation
- Praat, VoiceSauce, and Adobe Audition for speech recording, processing, and acoustic analysis
- Natural language processing (NLP) and computational linguistics techniques
- Surveys, interviews, and behavioural, eye-tracking, EEG, MEG, and fMRI experiments

LANGUAGES

- Chinese: Mandarin (native), Wu (native), Cantonese (native)
- English (IELTS Academic Band 8), Japanese (basic), Korean (basic)